

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Some people are just hard to manage!



Learning Outcome

Present advice on solving technical problems in a work context and appropriate for the interlocutor.

Can Do Statements

- I can deal with communication breakdown.
- I can give opinions.
- I can discuss behavior and personality.

Ask your partner:

- What problems might you have before an important event?
- What can you do to avoid them?





Let's Explore!

Miranda and Peter talk about a special request by one of the celebrities. What is it?



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Miranda:** Peter, help! Ricardo Verde needs wheelchair access.
- Peter:** I'm not sure I follow you. What happened to Ricardo?
- Miranda:** His daughter-in-law broke her leg last week but wants to attend.
- Peter:** Isn't this three days away? I don't think we can find a new building.
- Miranda:** Exactly. Ricardo is sensitive. If his daughter-in-law isn't provided for, he will cancel.
- Peter:** What would you say to helping her up the stairs?
- Miranda:** No, he's very contrary, if you ask me. Now he's blaming me for choosing a non-accessible facility. He's really crusty!
- Peter:** He's demanding! I say we build a ramp.
- Miranda:** You mean a wheelchair ramp?
- Peter:** Yes! I strongly believe the company we hired for the catwalk will have something.
- Miranda:** Don't you think it would be dangerous without a rail? Ricardo will throw a tantrum.
- Peter:** Hmmmm. What's your opinion of a temporary fence? I'd say it might not meet safety codes, but just this once ...
- Miranda:** Eh? What are you talking about?
- Peter:** Potted plants. We could rent solid urns with flowers to line up each side of the ramp.
- Miranda:** You are inventive!
- Peter:** Hire a porter for the front door and I'll take care of the inside.





Let's Practice!

According to Peter, Ricardo is demanding*!

*"Demanding": refers to a person who is not easily pleased or satisfied.

Instructions: Match the words on the right to their corresponding definition on the left.

- | | |
|--------------------|--|
| 1. sensitive | a. likely to become angry or upset easily |
| 2. inventive | b. suddenly behave in a very angry and unreasonable way |
| 3. crusty | c. easily annoyed |
| 4. throw a tantrum | d. inclined to disagree or to do the opposite of what is expected or desired |
| 5. contrary | e. good at thinking of new and original ideas |



Let's Practice!

He's very difficult to deal with, if you ask me.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence. Write each word in the correct order.

1) a / I / building / don't / we / can / new / . / think / find

_____.

2) say / stairs / would / her / ? / up / to / you / What / helping / the

_____.

3) a / we / build / . / I / ramp / say

_____.

4) provide / will / access / company / wheelchair / strongly / . / the / I / believe

_____.

5) dangerous / Don't / think / you / it / would / ? / be

_____.





Extension Activity

Problem-solve before the party!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- You have organized an office party for your company. However, you have some problems to deal with.
- Brainstorm and write down some problems you might have before the party (for example, provide wheelchair access).
- Write a short dialogue of 10-12 lines.
- In your dialogue, use expressions for dealing with communication breakdown and give opinions.
- When you are finished, read your dialogue to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write about problems I might have before a party.

☐
☐

I use language for dealing with communication breakdown.

☐
☐

I talk about my opinions.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **sensitive** (adjective): likely to become angry or upset easily
e.g. Ricardo is a very sensitive man.
- **contrary** (adjective): inclined to disagree or to do the opposite of what is expected or desired
e.g. He's very contrary to the idea of using the stairs.
- **crusty** (adjective): easily annoyed
e.g. He's blaming me for that. He's really crusty.
- **throw a tantrum** (expression): to suddenly behave in a very angry and unreasonable way
e.g. If we don't do it, Ricardo will throw a tantrum.
- **inventive** (adjective): good at thinking of new and original ideas
e.g. Peter, you're so inventive.





Learning Points

Dealing With Communication Breakdown

Sometimes you don't understand what was said or something was not clear to you. It is, therefore, important to express your lack of understanding and seek clarification from the person you are talking to.

Expressing lack of understanding	Asking for clarification
• <i>I'm not sure I follow you.</i> • <i>Eh?</i>	• <i>What happened to ... ?</i> • <i>Isn't ... ?</i> • <i>You mean ... ?</i> • <i>What are you talking about?</i>

Examples:

• **Ron:** *We need to make special arrangements.*

Ian: *I'm not sure I follow you. What are you talking about?*

Ron: *We need to provide wheelchair access.*

• **Ron:** *I don't think we can meet the safety codes.*

Ian: *Eh? You mean fire hazards?*





Learning Points

Giving Opinions

Conversations are far more interesting when people interact during the conversation. It is important to ask for others' opinions on a subject as well as giving your own. Here are some ways you can give opinions.

- *I (don't) think ... + clause*
- *What would you say to ... + verb + -ing ?*
- *... if you ask me.*
- *I say ... + clause*
- *I strongly believe (that) + clause*
- *Don't you think ... + clause?*
- *What's your opinion of ... + noun / -ing?*
- *I'd say ... + clause*
- *A verb in the imperative form - Hire / Move, etc. + clause*

Examples:

- *I don't think* we can find a new building.
- *What would you say to* making special arrangements?
- He's very contrary, *if you ask me*.
- *I strongly believe* we need to have wheelchair access.
- *What's your opinion of* building a temporary fence?
- *Hire* someone to work the front door and see to the guests.

